

Paul Skenes vs. Shohei Ohtani

THE GAME PLAN · RHP, PIT vs. bats L, LAD · Statcast through 2026-09-27

Three things to know

- Skenes throws his four-seam 45% of the time to lefties, and leans on his changeup with two strikes (17% overall, 25% with two strikes).
- Ohtani does his best damage against sinkers (xwOBA .474 in 80 PA; league .368) and struggles most against splitters (.288 in 39 PA).
- First pitch: the model expects a fastball 56% of the time, most likely his four-seam (52%).

HEAD TO HEAD

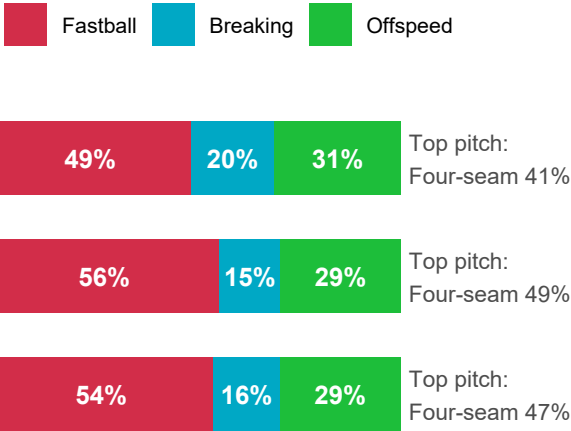
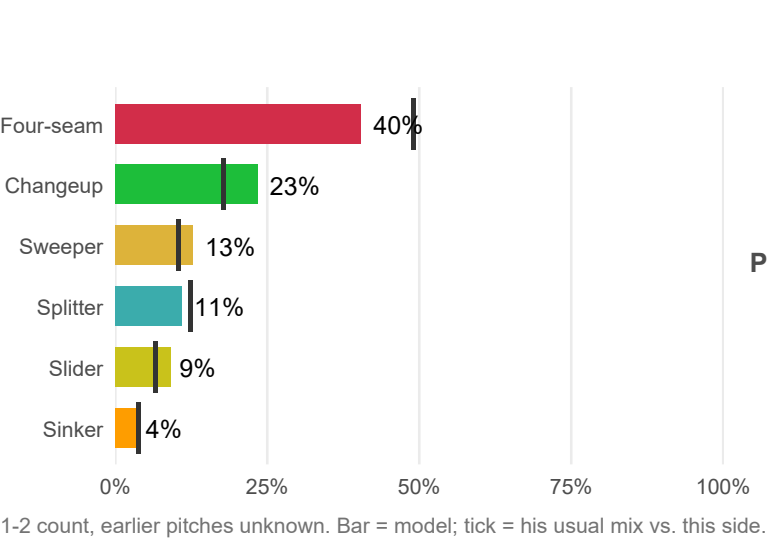
15 PA (2024-2026)
2 H · 1 HR
7 K · 1 BB
xwOBA .279

If it's 1-2...

Fastball 44% · Breaking 22% · Offspeed 34%

What he throws when...

2026, vs. lefties



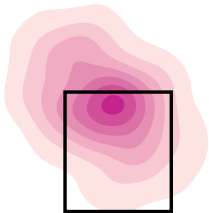
Pitch-by-pitch edge

Combines how Ohtani hits each pitch type and how Skenes's version of it performs (2025-26 xwOBA)

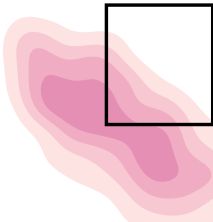
Four-seam	45% of pitches · 96.8 mph	Hitter edge: projected .382 vs. .350 avg
Changeup	17% of pitches · 88.6 mph	Even: projected .310 vs. .289 avg
Splitter	13% of pitches · 93.2 mph	Hitter edge: projected .335 vs. .260 avg
Slider	8% of pitches · 86.8 mph	Hitter edge: projected .360 vs. .311 avg
Sweeper	8% of pitches · 84.0 mph	Hitter edge: projected .338 vs. .309 avg
Sinker	8% of pitches · 96.6 mph	Hitter edge: projected .422 vs. .368 avg

Where his top three pitches go

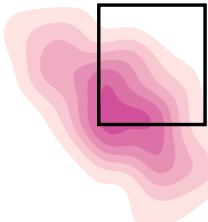
Four-seam (768)



Changeup (289)



Splitter (223)

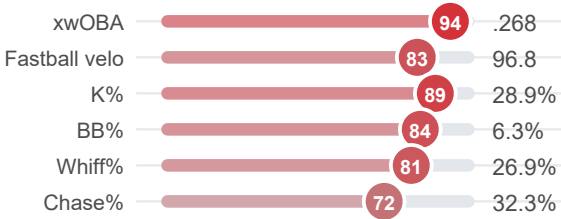


Catcher's view. Darker = more pitches. Public data shows where the ball ended up, not where the catcher set up.

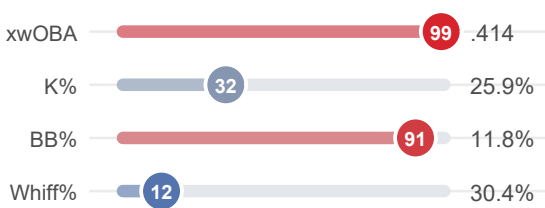
THE DETAIL

Paul Skenes vs. Shohei Ohtani · pitch mix and locations: 2026 · outcomes: 2025-26

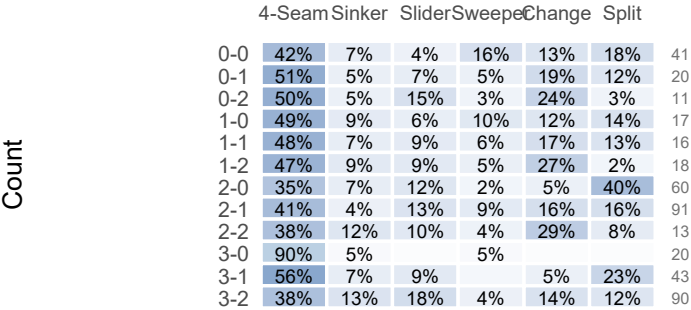
Paul Skenes percentiles



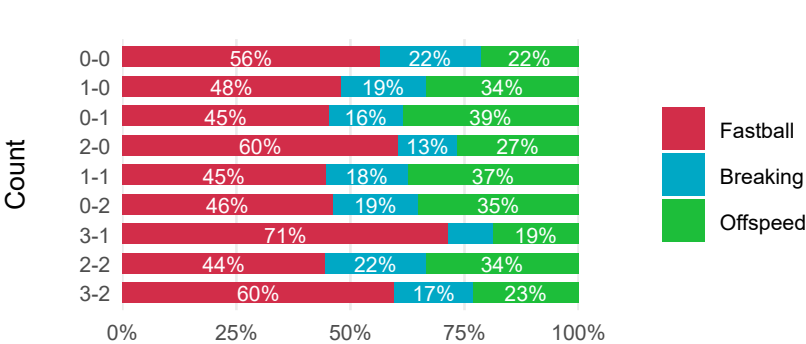
Shohei Ohtani percentiles



Actual mix by count vs. LHB, 2026



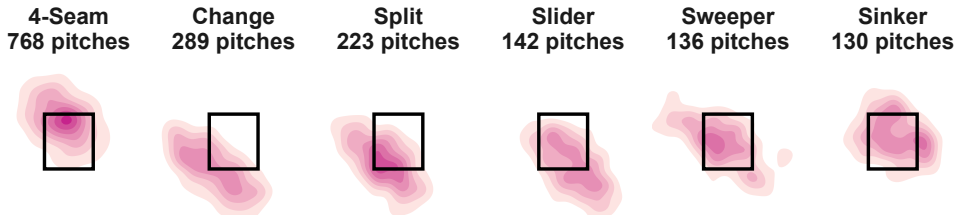
Model by count



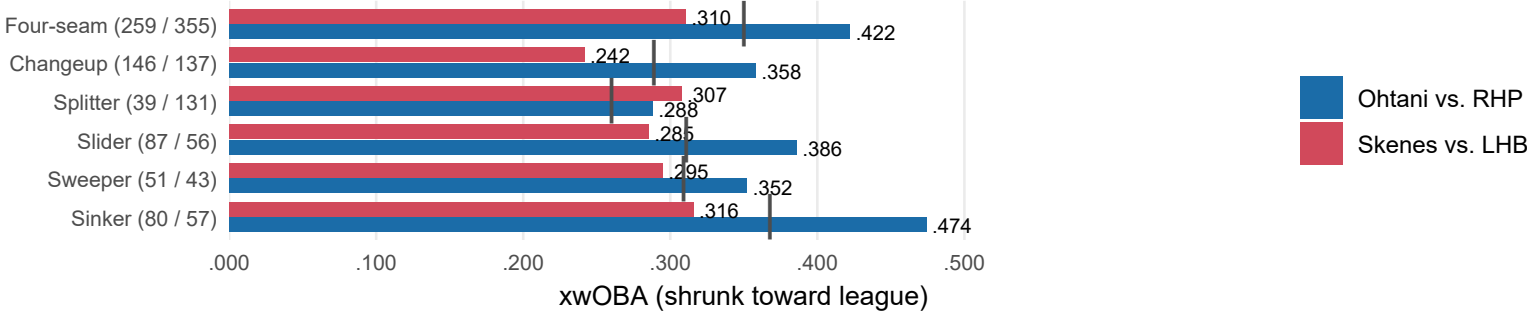
Faded rows: fewer than 30 pitches. Right column: pitches in that count.

Earlier pitches unknown, averaged over his usual mix.

All pitch locations



Expected outcomes by pitch type



2025-2026. Black tick = league average for that pitch and matchup. In parentheses: plate appearances (hitter / pitcher).

Arsenal vs. LHB

Pitch	Usage	Velo	H-brk	V-brk	Whiff	Chase	N
Four-seam	45%	96.8	-13	13	27%	29%	768
Changeup	17%	88.6	-15	6	34%	38%	289
Splitter	13%	93.2	-13	2	15%	36%	223
Slider	8%	86.8	3	2	29%	39%	142
Sweeper	8%	84.0	11	5	28%	16%	136
Sinker	8%	96.6	-17	7	17%	25%	130

Platoon splits (2025-26)

Player	Split	PA	xwOBA	K%	BB%
Skenes	vs LHB	805	.289	29.2%	7.7%
Skenes	vs RHB	634	.242	28.5%	4.6%
Ohtani	vs LHP	442	.377	26.7%	7.9%
Ohtani	vs RHP	861	.433	25.6%	13.8%

How to read this

- xwOBA: damage a hitter does, from quality of contact, walks and strikeouts (league about .320, elite .400). Whiff%: misses per swing. Chase%: swings at pitches outside the zone. Break: movement in inches vs. a spinless pitch. Percentiles: vs. all players with 150+ PA in 2025-26; red = better.
- The model: gradient boosting trained on 2023-25 Statcast, tested once on all of 2026. It starts from the pitcher's own mix and learns how count, previous pitches and matchup shift it. When it says 40%, that pitch came about 40% of the time in testing. Probabilities, not certainties.